

Google Ads API Tool Design - P3 Controlled Pilot

Google Drop 2026 | Basic Access application supporting document

1. Purpose and current status

The tool is a planned internal keyword-research and Google Ads campaign-planning utility for my own ecommerce project. Its first use is a small controlled pilot (P3) intended to test whether historical keyword metrics returned by the Google Ads API are consistent with metrics already collected manually from Google Keyword Planner.

Current status: the API pilot has not started. Google Ads API data is not currently replacing Google Keyword Planner data, and parity has not been established. Basic Access is being requested before any production-account API use.

2. Intended Google Ads API use

Permissible use requested	Researching keywords and recommendations
Primary service / method	KeywordPlanIdeaService - GenerateKeywordHistoricalMetrics
Purpose	Retrieve historical keyword metrics for a small, controlled set of keywords to support planning for future Google Ads campaigns for my own ecommerce project.
Campaign mutations	None during P3. No campaign, ad group, ad, keyword, budget, billing, or bid creation/update operations.
Third-party account management	None. The tool will not manage Google Ads accounts belonging to clients or other companies.

3. Pilot workflow and data flow

- **Step 1 - Manual baseline:** A small set of keywords is first measured using a manual Google Keyword Planner export. This export remains the reference baseline for the pilot.
- **Step 2 - Controlled API request:** The same keyword set and matching planning parameters are submitted through GenerateKeywordHistoricalMetrics after Basic Access is granted and authentication is configured.
- **Step 3 - Separate capture:** Returned API metrics are stored separately from the manual Keyword Planner export so source provenance remains clear.
- **Step 4 - Side-by-side comparison:** The tool compares the API result with the previously captured manual export and records agreements, differences, and unavailable values.
- **Step 5 - Human review:** Results are reviewed manually. No campaign action is triggered automatically from the comparison.

4. Intended users and audience

The tool is for internal use only. The intended users are the applicant and internal collaborators working on the applicant's own ecommerce research and advertising planning. It will not be offered to the public, sold, licensed, or provided to advertising clients.

5. Functional boundaries

In scope for P3	Out of scope for P3
Keyword historical-metric retrieval	Campaign creation or modification
Keyword planning support	Budget or billing changes
Comparison with manual Keyword Planner exports	Bid management or automated optimization
Internal research output	Third-party client account management
Human-reviewed planning decisions	Public or client-facing API access

6. Controls and safeguards

- The developer token and future OAuth credentials will be treated as secrets and will not be included in reports or screenshots.
- P3 is intentionally small and controlled; only a limited set of already-measured keywords will be used for the initial comparison.
- API-derived values and manual Keyword Planner values will remain source-labelled and will not be silently merged or substituted.
- A discrepancy will be recorded as a discrepancy; it will not be interpreted as proof that either source is automatically correct.
- Any future expansion into campaign creation, management, additional users, or materially different API functionality would require a separate review of the applicable Google Ads API permissions and policies before implementation.

7. Expected output

The pilot output is an internal comparison record showing the keyword, the manual Keyword Planner observation, the corresponding Google Ads API historical metric, and the comparison result. The output is used only as evidence for deciding whether the API can be relied on for future Google Ads keyword planning. No advertising campaign is launched or changed by the tool.

8. Architecture summary

Internal operator	Selects the controlled keyword set and planning parameters.
Google Ads API client (planned)	Authenticates and sends the historical-metrics request using the applicant's developer token after required access is approved.
Google Ads API	Returns KeywordPlanIdeaService historical keyword metrics.
Comparison layer	Keeps manual and API results separate, aligns comparable fields, and records differences.
Internal review output	Presents the comparison for human planning decisions only.

Official policy references

Google Ads API - Access Levels and Permissible Use:
<https://developers.google.com/google-ads/api/docs/api-policy/access-levels>

Google Ads API policies: <https://support.google.com/adspolicy/answer/6169371?hl=en>

Prepared for the Google Ads API Basic Access application. No developer token, OAuth secret, refresh token, or other credential is included in this document.